ICT Skills

The big idea

ICT stands for **Information and Communication Technology** – all the devices and tools we use to create, store, share and communicate information: computers, smartphones, tablets, the Internet, e-mail and more. This chapter covers the parts of a computer, starting and shutting it down, using the keyboard and mouse, and managing **files and folders**.

ICT tools

- **Smartphones and tablets** – touch-screen devices for calls, apps, Internet.
- **Computers (desktop/laptop)** – for typing, calculations, presentations, coding.
- **Internet, e-mail, video calls, social media** – for communication.

Parts of a computer

Part	Type	Function
Keyboard, mouse, scanner, microphone	**Input devices**	Enter data and commands
CPU (Central Processing Unit)	Processing	The "brain" – processes instructions
Monitor, printer, speakers	**Output devices**	Show or give results
RAM, hard disk, pen drive	**Memory/storage**	Store data temporarily or permanently

Hardware = physical parts you can touch. **Software** = programs (e.g. Windows, Ubuntu, LibreOffice).

Basic computer operations

- **Starting (booting)**: press the power button; the computer runs a **POST (Power-On Self-Test)**, then loads the **operating system**. Log in with your username and password.
- **Desktop**: the first screen, with icons, taskbar/panel and a start menu or app launcher.
- **Shutting down**: save your work, close programs, then **Start > Power > Shut down** (Windows) or the system menu → **Power Off** (Ubuntu). Never just switch off the main supply.

Using the mouse and keyboard

- **Click** (left button once) – select. **Double-click** – open. **Right-click** – open the context menu. **Drag and drop** – hold the left button to move an item. **Scroll** – use the wheel.
- Keyboard keys: **Enter** (confirm/new line), **Backspace** (delete left), **Delete** (delete right/selected), **Shift** (capitals), **Caps Lock**, **Tab**, **Spacebar**, **arrow keys**, and **Ctrl/Alt** for shortcuts.

Files and folders

A **file** is a named collection of data (a document, image, song). Its **extension** tells its type: `.odt`, `.txt`, `.jpg`, `.mp3`, `.pdf`. A **folder** (directory) holds files and other folders (sub-folders), like a cupboard with drawers.

MANAGING FILES (UBUNTU FILES / WINDOWS FILE EXPLORER)

- **Create a folder**: open a location → right-click empty space → **New Folder** → type name → Enter.

- **Rename**: select → **F2** (or right-click → Rename).
- **Copy**: select → **Ctrl+C** → open destination → **Ctrl+V**.
- **Move**: **Ctrl+X** then **Ctrl+V** (or drag to another folder).
- **Delete**: select → **Delete** (goes to **Trash/Recycle Bin**, can be restored).
- **Search**: type the name in the search box.

COPY VS MOVE

Copy keeps the original and makes a duplicate. Move (cut-paste) removes it from the old place.

Internet and e-mail basics

A **web browser** (Firefox, Chrome) opens websites using their address (**URL**). A **search engine** (Google, Bing) helps find information. An **e-mail address** looks like `name@domain.com`; an e-mail has **To, Cc, Bcc, Subject, Body** and can carry **attachments**.

SAVE OFTEN

Press **Ctrl+S** every few minutes. Power cuts do not wait for you to finish!

Quick recap

- ICT = devices and tools to handle and share information.
- Input → CPU → output; storage keeps data.
- Boot, log in, use the desktop, shut down properly.
- Mouse: click, double-click, right-click, drag. Files have extensions; folders organise them.
- Ctrl+C copy, Ctrl+X cut, Ctrl+V paste, F2 rename.

Practice questions

1. Which of these is an input device?
   (a) Monitor (b) Printer (c) Keyboard (d) Speaker
2. ICT stands for
   (a) Internet and Computer Technology (b) Information and Communication Technology (c) Indian Computer Training (d) Information and Computer Typing
3. Which mouse action usually opens a file or folder?
   (a) Single click (b) Right-click (c) Double-click (d) Scrolling
4. The shortcut to paste a copied file is
   (a) Ctrl+C (b) Ctrl+X (c) Ctrl+P (d) Ctrl+V
5. Which key is used to rename a selected file?
   (a) F2 (b) F5 (c) F11 (d) Esc
6. The test a computer runs on itself when it is switched on is called
   (a) RAM (b) URL (c) POST (d) GUI
7. Differentiate between a file and a folder.
8. Write the steps to (i) create a new folder (ii) copy a file into it (iii) shut down the computer properly.

Answers: 1. c 2. b 3. c 4. d 5. a 6. c 7. see notes 8. see notes